PROactive PRONUNCIATION

De-Stressed “To”

The word “to” is a special function word. Because it is unstressed, English speakers tend to reduce the pronunciation to a simple “tuh” rather than “too” when a consonant follows it. If the “to” is followed by a vowel; however, the “to” will be pronounced as “too.” For example, “going to go” is pronounced “tuh,” where “to our place” would be pronounced “too.”

according to legend
appeal to the masses
back to back
bound to happen
cater to you
come to terms with it
it comes down to you
cut to the chase
day to day
desire to love
down to earth
drink to that
end to end
eye to eye
face to face
fall to the ground
get to go
go to my place
go to our place
have to understand
he’s dressed to the nines
head to toe
hold on to your hat
hot to trot
I’ll see to it
in order to get there
it boils down to this
it’s up to date
kept up to speed
lead to win
lean into it
learn to speak Mandarin
live up to your standard
look forward to it
look up to you
need to get around
next to me
not to mention
on to the next
people to see
places to explore
put down to paper
read to learn more
refer to the sign
resort to jokes
right to privacy
side to side
so to speak
speak to that point
stand up to him
stick to it
straight to the point
subject to reason
thanks to you
time to time
to and fro
to begin with
to no avail
turn to your partner
up to no good
used to do it
want to understand
way to go
what to do
where to go
will come to pass
willing to forgive
year to date
your right to vote